the US and EU that hinder the growth of global trade.
- Chinese and Indian economists occupy a second tier of the bureaucracies in the World Bank and IMF.
- Climate negotiations at the global scale increasingly revolve around Washington's managed relations with BRICS countries, first through the deal done in 2009 in Copenhagen (involving four of the five BRICS) and then the US-China emissions cuts agreed to bilaterally in 2014.
- In other bilateral relations with South Africa and India, US President Barack Obama made substantial progress in trips, respectively, during 2013 (twice) and 2015.
- Soccer remains the most symbolic and profitable commercial component of sports in the imperialist project, with FIFA machinery controlling the game's World Cup in alliance with elites from host countries South Africa, Brazil and Russia from 2010 to 2018, no matter the vast social costs involved in White Elephant stadium construction and suppression of local unrest. To add insult to injury, key BRICS countries supported Blatter's continual re-election to world soccer managerial leadership, notwithstanding vast evidence of wrongdoing during his five-term reign.

But there is also countervailing evidence:

- Several members of the BRICS have resisted demands by Western countries to impose stricter intellectual property controls (in the case of medicines this has saved millions of lives, especially in South Africa).
- Geopolitically, some BRICS leaders boldly challenged Washington after revelations of espionage by whistleblower Edward Snowden and before Washington's proposed bombing of Syria in 2013. In March 2014, the BRICS implicitly supported Russia in the conflict over Crimea, for which the G7 imposed sanctions and expelled Moscow (Putin had originally been scheduled to host the G8 meeting in Sochi a few weeks later). BRICS foreign ministers even successfully threatened to withdraw from the subsequent G20 summit in Australia in late 2014, were it to have become a G19 without Russia.
- In May 2014, Russia agreed to supply gas to China using local currencies, not the US dollar, seeking to partially reduce Russia's dependence on sales to the European market as sanctions resulting from the Ukraine chaos loomed.
- In early 2015, dramatic economic developments began unfolding as this book went to press, as emerging markets faced financial stress, as the Russian rouble crashed because of sanctions and the oil price collapse, and as China initiated